Amanda Masis

LIS804 01

OBJECT EXAMINATION REPORT

Title: Poetry Loves Poetry: An Anthology of Los Angeles Poets

Creation Date: 1985

Publisher: Momentum Press. Santa Monica, CA (1976-1995)

Author(s): Bill Mohr (Editor)

Physical Description: Softcover; xv, 408 pgs, 61 unnumbered plates

Dimensions: 22cm x 14 cm

Object Materials:

- Cover - gloss medium-weight paper
- Pages - light-weight dull paper
- Binding - glue

Extent of Damage:

- Cover: Water(?) and Coffee(?) stains throughout, top and bottom right-hand corners are bent, crease line down the front left side, tattered top and bottom edges, wrinkles throughout
- Spine: Split into three, spine cover is peeled off with much of it missing, stained, tattered edges along the right side and tops and bottoms, detached from cover, and the glue is peeling.
- Back Cover: Bent corners, tattered bottom edge, water stains throughout
- Text Block: Some discoloration throughout, bent corners throughout, minor wrinkling of pages throughout, 4 pages have come loose from the text block

Provenance: This book was purchased at The Last Book Store in Los Angeles, CA, for $5 in fair condition in 2016. There is no marginalia or ephemera found in the book that can give clues as to who owned this book before or where it came from. It's likely it belonged to someone's personal collection.

Poetry Loves Poetry is a very special anthology for me. It's a book that really captures a lot of the essence of Los Angeles as I knew it and as my parents knew it when they first immigrated to the US in the 70s and 80s, respectively. Growing up in a place like LA, where so much history happens but so little of it is respected or preserved (I think last year several dozen of the city's unofficial landmarks shut down), you get scared that overdevelopment is going to erase the collective memory you're a part of. A book like this offers insight into personal experiences of place; it reminds me of an idea I first came across in photographer Diane Arbus: "the more specific the more universal".

It was important to preserve this book because of its contents and also because the press it was printed on, Momentum Press, is a part of Los Angeles' literary history. In thinking through how to preserve this book, it was most important to make it into something that could be read and passed down. I mean the repairs to be part restoration/conservation and part art-binding. The book is in pretty rough shape and needs to have its physical form reimagined. In coming up with the treatment plan, I wanted to keep the cover, which to me is a beautiful and somewhat banal representation of Los Angeles (Strip mall gas stations, blue skies, and palm trees). A lot of the thought process was driven by a sentimentality that emerges from the text, the history of the book, and my own lived experiences.

165: *To Hughes Tool Company*

At the very last minute
I grab a bite to eat
and rattle into Playa Vista.
Wasted days and wasted nights and days is how I cruise
the urban wreckage, sift through the skimull for
ideals: Fox won't have a place to creep,
Hawk bereft of hunting grounds, no place for mallard duck
to rest on his migrations. I mean,
what's more important? Real estate millions
or the way sunset emblazons puff balls in the Ballonas Wetlands,
last wetlands left in L.A. County, delta where Ballonas Creek
and the Pacific Ocean do their seasonal dance to the tides.
Soon I'll be able to walk out here on a
redwood platform and buy souvenirs—cartoon ducks
in redwood taste—Playa Vista built by the Summa Corp.,
shadowy Howard Hughes Tool emanation conceived in Hughes'
sinazy twilight as a guest of the dictator in the sealed-off top floor
of the Managua, Nicaragua Holiday Inn. Soon there'll be more people
in Ballonas than in Century City, land where snowy egrets strolled
with scissor bills and curlews and great blue herons for thousands
and thousands of years! HUMAN RACISM!

Motorcycle policeman

that ticketed me for jaywalking
my first day in Los Angeles, tell me again
that you can't change Los Angeles.
Ducks fuck off around these parts. Deer, motherfucker, disappear.
Like a terrible freeway collision you don't want to
bum people out about, you can just take your Playa Vista subdivision
and slide it back out a black hole. Like children spilling
from the bed of a pick-up truck on a freeway at rush hour, blood-gallons
turning dark brown, we don't need Playa Vista.
We don't have to have it.
We're better off without it.

166: *Beirut*

Words, Lewis MacAdams; Lyrics, The Dark Bob
© 1982 High Performance Records

Beirut, for the last four nights I've been thinking
But my mind has been strangled up with fire.
So if I don't scream for you tonight, Beirut,

so moving
to the life

then she sh
Tara Tiesta
whole damn
rolls up aga
her fingers
on the wet
want her ag
one great p
don't know
into her Ch
I smell bloo
her face as
glows in the

296:

you bring
all the lost
new life at
happy dea

my pocket
that is to sa
please acce
a cold quar
(one dollar
this limping
my whole b

297:

On Isla Pati
in the Sinai
there are fi
Four of the
into the co

Peter Levitt

167: *The Turn*

Right now there is a blue jay
startling a bush
of coral meokey flowers.
I want to talk with you.
Have you noticed the in-
cessant greenness of the leaves,
the way all the frogs either
chatter at once or suddenly
stop? How people seem to
likewise come and come
and then are gone? When
I look at my hands the twins
of Gemini are mere
abstraction and the love
there in the delicate
pale walls of my arteries
is all. Have you noticed
how everything is either
moving or standing still?
And eventually all that stops?

168: *"Mother you will die"*

Mother you will die
and I

will have spent
my whole

life trying
to regain

"Poetry Loves Poetry"

ISBN 0-936054-50-6
$17.95

$17.50

Bill Mohr

An Anthology of Los Angeles Poets

Bill Mohr

Low Clouds © 1984 by Sandra Mendelsohn Rubin

OBJECT TREATMENT PROPOSAL

I. BOOK COVERS AND OUTER SPINE (BOOK CASE)

The covers of the book are in fairly poor condition. They are stained, creased, scratched, and separated from the spine cover. However, in the case of this book, I think the wear adds something to the story of the object, and I want to preserve the front and back covers. The spine cover is too damaged to be saved.

Treatment Plan:

The book will have to go from a softcover to a hardcover book. A new board will have to be cut to size and wrapped in cloth. Endpapers will have to be installed within the book. In order to save the front and back covers and utilize them in the rebinding process, I have two ideas to work with. Both involve creating a cover inset.

The cover inset is made by first cutting the board to size, marking out the area that the cover image will take up, and debossing (or peeling back a layer) of the board so that the area where the image will go is sunk in a bit from the rest of the cover. The next step would be to wrap the board in fabric (I am thinking a nice blue-toned grey or neutral linen) and glue it down. The image would then be glued down into the divot created.

The two options for the cover would be:

1. Using the original covers in the inset and making the board a bit larger than the text block.
2. Scanning the covers, resizing them to be about 40-60% smaller, and having them printed out on archival photo paper to use for the cover. In this case, I would create an envelope/pocket in the back of the new book binding, made from archival acid-free paper, and insert the covers to keep them together with the book, but not in use.

Option 2 is most likely what I would go with as it keeps the parts of the book together and is the most friendly to preserving the original covers from further damage. It allows me to play with placement and scale and to create a special feature for the book.

II. TEXT BLOCK & BINDING

The text block was bound with a perfect binding method. Several pages of the text block have come loose, and the glue has chipped off in several areas along the top and bottom edges of the spine. The pages are perforated along the binding and can be safely separated from the glue if handled carefully. As the pages are individual sheets and not in folded signatures, they will have to be bound in a method that works for single sheets.

My first choice would be a sewn binding to avoid having to deal with the glue becoming brittle again. After measuring the gutter and margins, it seems that the sewn binding options for single-sheet books aren't compatible. This leaves me with glue. After going over class notes and doing a bit of research online, I decided on a double fan adhesive bind as this seems to be

the most durable glue bind and something that I can execute with my home binding setup. I would add folded endpapers to the front and back that would be points of attachment to the cover/case. I would also add a spine lining as another point of attachment to the cover/case.

Taking the newly repaired text block, I would glue it into the case. After this, I would glue in the envelope to house the original covers.